

Goldman From Zero

What the firm actually is, how it makes money, and every 2027 London Summer Analyst role explained for someone starting with no finance knowledge at all

Role list pulled from Goldman's own live recruiting system, 15 Aug 2026 · plain English throughout · jargon defined in the glossary at the end

Start here: the one idea that unlocks everything

Goldman Sachs is **not a bank like Barclays or HSBC**. You cannot open a current account there. It has no branches. Instead, it does difficult financial work for the world's biggest clients — **companies, governments, pension funds, insurance companies, hedge funds, and very wealthy families** — and charges fees for it.

Everything the firm does fits one sentence: **clients with money problems too big or complex to solve themselves pay Goldman to solve them**. A company wants to buy a rival. A government wants to borrow billions. A pension fund needs its money invested for thirty years. A hedge fund wants to trade at scale. Every division below is just a different flavour of that one sentence — and every summer role is a seat inside one of those flavours.

PART 1 — Understanding the firm

The four kinds of client, and what each pays for

Client	Their problem	What Goldman does
Companies & governments	"We want to buy a rival / sell ourselves / raise money to grow"	Advises on the deal, arranges the financing, runs the process (this is <i>investment banking</i>)
Investors (hedge funds, asset managers)	"We need to buy and sell huge amounts of shares, bonds and currencies without moving the price"	Trades with them and for them, all day, in every market (this is <i>sales & trading</i>)
Institutions with long-term money (pension funds, insurers, charities)	"Invest our billions well for decades"	Manages their money for an annual fee (this is <i>asset management</i>)
Very wealthy people & families	"Look after everything — investments, borrowing, planning"	Runs their entire financial life (this is <i>wealth management</i>)

The map: how the firm is organised

Global Banking & Markets (GBM)

The classic "Goldman" people imagine. Two halves:

Investment Banking

(advising companies on deals and fundraising) and

FICC & Equities

(the trading floor, buying and selling for investor clients). Earns fees per deal and per trade.

Asset & Wealth Management (AWM)

The firm as money manager.

Asset Management

invests institutions' money (over \$3 trillion supervised firmwide);

Wealth Management

serves rich individuals and families. Earns ongoing fees for every day a client stays.

Engineering & Quant Strats

The builders and mathematicians embedded everywhere: trading systems, risk models, platforms, data. Roughly a quarter of the firm's people.

"The Core" (control & support functions)

Risk, Compliance, Operations, Controllers (finance), HR and more — the teams that let a firm handling trillions do it safely and legally.

The money — who earns what (2025, real numbers)



\$41.5bn
Global Banking & Markets

≈\$16–17bn
Asset & Wealth Management

Total firm revenue in 2025: **\$58.3 billion**. Inside GBM: equities trading \$16.5bn, fixed-income trading \$14.5bn, investment banking fees \$9.3bn. So GBM earns far more — but here is the beginner insight that most applicants never grasp: **the two divisions earn different kinds of money**. GBM's fees are *episodic*: every deal and every trade must be won again tomorrow. AWM's management fees are *recurring*: they tick daily on trillions for as long as clients stay. Investors value recurring revenue more, which is why the smaller division is the firm's stated growth priority — and why client relationships there are treated as the crown jewels.

How the divisions connect — "One Goldman Sachs"

The divisions are not silos; they pass clients to each other, and the firm has an official name for this: **One Goldman Sachs**, announced by CEO David Solomon in his first weeks — deliver the whole firm to every client. Concrete examples:

- Investment Banking floats a founder's company → the founder is suddenly worth £300m → **Wealth Management** looks after it.
- A pension fund trades through the **markets desks** for years → eventually hands its entire portfolio to **Asset Management** to run.
- A hedge fund launches → **prime brokerage** (part of the markets business) finances it → it becomes a trading client, a research client, everything.

Keep this idea nearby: several of the most interesting summer seats exist precisely to *conduct* this one-firm machine for a single client.

PART 2 — Every 2027 London Summer Analyst role, from zero

All 23 roles below were live on Goldman's application system when pulled (15 Aug 2026). Tags: **CLIENT-FACING** = relationships are the job · **INVESTING/MARKETS** = markets judgement is the job · **TECHNICAL** = building/math is the job · **CONTROL/ENABLING** = keeping the machine safe is the job. "Your summer" lines describe typical intern work — team-dependent.

Global Banking & Markets

Investment Banking, Classic req 170929 **CLIENT-FACING**

What the team does: advises companies on the biggest decisions of their lives — buying another company (M&A), selling themselves, listing on the stock market (an IPO), or borrowing billions. Goldman is historically the world's #1 M&A adviser.

Your summer: building financial models valuing companies, preparing presentation decks for client meetings, checking numbers late into the night. The famous hours are real; so is the training.

Pick it if: you want the classic prestige path, deep company analysis, and don't fear the workload. The most applied-to seat in the building.

Investment Banking, Capital Solutions Group req 170927 **CLIENT-FACING**

What the team does: same division, newer team — designs creative financing for companies using private capital (money from funds rather than public markets), the fastest-growing corner of finance.

Your summer: similar to IB Classic — modelling and materials — but centred on financing structures rather than takeovers.

Pick it if: IB appeals but you'd rather be where the industry is heading than where it's been; likely thinner applicant pool than Classic.

FICC & Equities (Sales & Trading) req 170675 **CLIENT-FACING** **MARKETS**

What the team does: the trading floor. FICC = fixed income (bonds), currencies and commodities; Equities = shares. Traders quote prices and manage risk; salespeople own the relationships with investor clients, feeding them ideas, research and market colour all day. This is the world of the equities panel you may have seen at insight events — the "conductor of the orchestra" seat.

Your summer: rotations across desks — shadowing traders, building market summaries, pitching trade ideas, learning products fast.

Pick it if: you love markets moving in real time and want relationships plus adrenaline. Suits quick, sociable, resilient people.

Transaction Banking (TxB), Coverage req 162040 **CLIENT-FACING**

What the team does: runs payments, foreign exchange and cash management for corporate treasurers — Goldman's youngest banking business, pitched as "a 150-year-old firm with the agility of a tech start-up." Coverage = the client-relationship arm.

Your summer: supporting client coverage — researching prospects, preparing materials, joining client calls, mapping treasury needs.

Pick it if: you want genuine client contact early, in a growing business most students overlook — the classic lower-competition, high-exposure choice.

Asset & Wealth Management — Asset Management side

Asset Management, Client Solutions Group req 171037 **CLIENT-FACING**

What the team does: the client-facing arm of the \$3tn asset manager. Wins, onboards and keeps the institutions whose money Goldman invests — pension funds, sovereign wealth funds, insurers, charities, and the advisers who distribute funds. Owns the whole client lifecycle: first meeting, formal proposals (RFPs), final pitches, onboarding, then the quarterly reviews that keep a mandate for decades.

Your summer: preparing client meeting decks and portfolio review packs, drafting RFP answers, researching client segments, joining calls, learning the shelf of products.

Pick it if: you're motivated by clients and long-term relationships rather than picking stocks — the purest relationship career in AWM.

Asset Management, Public Investing req 173051 INVESTING

What the team does: the actual fund managers for public markets — researching shares and bonds, building portfolios that pension funds and others pay Goldman to run.

Your summer: researching companies, building models, pitching stock ideas to portfolio managers.

Pick it if: you want to be an investor — the buy-side version of equity research.

Asset Management, Private Investing req 173050 INVESTING

What the team does: invests client money in things you can't buy on an exchange — whole companies (private equity), loans to companies (private credit), property and infrastructure. Goldman runs \$600bn+ of these "alternatives," among the world's largest.

Your summer: analysing deals — company financials, debt structures, downside cases — alongside deal teams.

Pick it if: you want deal-level investing; among the most competitive seats in AWM, small intake.

Asset Management, Change Management req 171031 ENABLING

What the team does: runs the projects that change how the asset manager works — new systems, process redesign, regulatory change.

Your summer: project support — tracking workstreams, process mapping, coordinating between teams.

Pick it if: you like organising complex delivery more than markets themselves.

Asset Management, UX Design req 171028 TECHNICAL

What the team does: designs the digital products and interfaces the asset manager's clients and teams use.

Your summer: design research, wireframes, prototypes. A design portfolio matters more than finance knowledge.

Pick it if: you're a designer who wants finance-scale problems — a specialist path.

Asset & Wealth Management — Wealth Management side

Wealth Management, Private Wealth Management req 170879 CLIENT-FACING

What the team does: advises ultra-wealthy individuals, families and their foundations (think £10m+ of investable money) on everything: investing, borrowing, planning, life. Relationships here last generations.

Your summer: supporting advisor teams — portfolio analysis, market updates, meeting preparation, client research. (Also offered as a one-year placement.)

Pick it if: you want the deepest personal client relationships in finance and can hold a conversation with anyone.

Wealth Management, Quantitative Finance req 170860 TECHNICAL

What the team does: builds the maths behind wealth management — portfolio analytics, risk models, optimisation tools advisors use with clients.

Your summer: coding and modelling — Python-type work on real portfolio problems.

Pick it if: you're quantitative but want your models near clients rather than near markets.

Wealth Management, Product Management & Design req 170935 **TECHNICAL**

What the team does: builds the wealth platform itself — banking, lending and digital products wealthy clients use.

Your summer: product work — user research, feature specs, coordinating engineers and stakeholders.

Pick it if: you think like a product manager — tech-company work at a bank.

Engineering & Quantitative Strats

Engineering req 170644 **TECHNICAL**

What the team does: software engineering across everything — trading systems, risk platforms, data, cyber. One of the world's larger tech organisations hiding inside a bank.

Your summer: writing real code on a real team. Note: the selection process includes a **HackerRank coding test** — unique to this track.

Pick it if: you can code and want scale, pace and pay — without necessarily being a "finance person" at all.

Quantitative Strats — four flavours: **The Core** 175426, **Investment Banking** 175428, **Asset & Wealth Mgmt** 175421, **FICC & Equities** 175424 **TECHNICAL** **MARKETS**

What the teams do: "strats" are Goldman's quants — mathematicians and programmers who build pricing models, risk engines and analytics. Same craft, four homes: on the trading floor (pricing and risk), in banking (deal analytics), in AWM (portfolio analytics), or in the Core (firmwide platforms).

Your summer: building models with real data — expect probability, coding and hard problems daily.

Pick it if: maths-heavy degree, love of modelling. Choose the flavour by which world you want your maths to live in.

The Core — control & enabling functions

Risk req 172894 **CONTROL**

What the team does: measures and manages every risk the firm takes — market moves, borrowers defaulting, systems failing — so one bad day can't sink the firm. Increasingly quantitative (big data, cloud).

Your summer: analysing exposures, stress-testing portfolios, supporting risk reviews.

Pick it if: analytical, careful, interested in markets from the "what could go wrong" side.

Compliance req 170152 **CONTROL**

What the team does: keeps the firm inside the law and its own standards — monitoring trading, advising the business on rules, managing regulator relationships.

Your summer: surveillance reviews, policy research, supporting advisory work.

Pick it if: you like rules, judgement calls and protecting an institution — a genuine profession, steadier hours.

Operations req 170158 **CONTROL**

What the team does: makes every trade actually happen — settlement, payments, fixing what breaks. The posting's own line: "for every trade agreed... it is Operations that enables business to flow."

Your summer: working a real process — investigating breaks, improving workflows, seeing how the machine truly runs.

Pick it if: you want to understand the plumbing of markets and improve systems; a common launchpad to many careers.

Controllers req 170163 **CONTROL**

What the team does: the firm's own accountants — financial reporting, regulatory numbers, checking the books balance across worldwide markets. (Also offered as a one-year placement.)

Your summer: reporting cycles, reconciliations, working with the businesses on their numbers.

Pick it if: accounting/finance-minded; a strong route to qualified-accountant-style careers inside banking.

Human Capital Management req 170145 **ENABLING**

What the team does: the people function — recruiting, development, pay, workforce strategy for tens of thousands of employees.

Your summer: supporting recruiting or talent projects, people analytics.

Pick it if: you want a people-centred career at a firm where talent is literally the product.

Office of Regulatory Relations req 170160 **CONTROL**

What the team does: manages the firm's day-to-day relationships with its regulators — exams, inquiries, coordination. Small, specialist.

Your summer: supporting regulatory responses and tracking. **Pick it if:** policy/regulation genuinely interests you.

Corporate & Workplace Solutions req 170173 **ENABLING**

What the team does: runs the firm itself — buildings, workplace services, procurement, commercial management.

Your summer: projects across real estate, vendor or workplace analytics. **Pick it if:** operations/management interests over markets.

Worth knowing: there is **no London Summer Analyst role in Global Investment Research this cycle** — research (analysts who publish views on companies and economies) is offered in London only as separate off-cycle internships. If research is your goal, that's the route. Also note Wealth Management PWM and Controllers each offer a one-year placement variant alongside the summer role.

PART 3 — Choosing your four

The hard rule, from the posting itself: a maximum of **4 business/location combinations per recruiting year** — a 5th application auto-withdraws an earlier one — and never use multiple email addresses (the system detects it). Your four choices are scarce: spend them deliberately, not reactively.

Three questions that sort the whole list:

1. **People, positions, or platforms?** If relationships energise you → the **CLIENT-FACING** seats (S&T sales, CSG, PWM, TxB, IB). If markets judgement → **INVESTING** seats. If building → **TECHNICAL**. If safeguarding and process → **CONTROL**.
2. **Episodic or recurring?** Deals-and-trades adrenaline (GBM) versus decade-long client relationships (AWM). Neither is better; they are different lives.
3. **Where does your evidence point?** Screeners check whether your CV's story matches the seat you chose. Apply where your experience already makes the case — a mismatch wastes one of your four bullets.

Competitiveness (informed judgement, not published data): IB Classic, S&T and AM Private Investing draw the biggest crowds; TxB Coverage, Capital Solutions, and most Core functions draw far thinner fields for genuinely strong seats.

PART 4 — Mini glossary (the jargon, decoded)

M&A	Mergers & acquisitions — companies buying, selling or combining with each other.
IPO	Initial public offering — a private company listing its shares on a stock exchange for the first time.
FICC	Fixed Income, Currencies and Commodities — trading everything that isn't shares: bonds, FX, oil, metals.
Equities	Shares in companies — and the business of trading them.
Sell side / buy side	Sell side = banks like Goldman that provide trading, research and advice. Buy side = investors (funds) who buy those services and invest capital.
Mandate	A client's formal appointment of a manager to run a pot of money ("a £400m equity mandate").
AUM / AUS	Assets under management / supervision — the total client money a firm runs; the base its fees are charged on.
RFP	Request for Proposal — the formal questionnaire institutions send when choosing a manager; winning starts here.
Alternatives	Investments outside public markets: private equity, private credit, property, infrastructure.
Private credit	Funds lending directly to companies instead of banks or bond markets — finance's fastest-growing area.
Prime brokerage	The suite of services (financing, custody, stock borrowing) banks provide to hedge funds.
Custodian	The institution that safekeeps investments and settles trades on an investor's behalf.
Derivative	A contract whose value derives from something else (a share, a rate, oil) — used to hedge or take positions.
OCIO	Outsourced Chief Investment Officer — an institution handing its entire investment function to a manager like Goldman.
Spring week	A UK first/second-year insight programme at a bank — the standard early pipeline into summer internships.

Sources & caveats. Role list and division descriptions: Goldman's live recruiting system (all 23 requisitions, pulled 15 Aug 2026) — titles and req IDs verbatim. Firm financials: Goldman's FY2025 results. One Goldman Sachs: the firm's published history. "Your summer" descriptions and competitiveness notes are informed judgement about typical intern work, not Goldman statements — the live posting and the recruiting team always override this document. Companion deep-dives in this series: the application machine (docs 10–12), the CSG role (13), GSAM (15).